



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*dharma.pradhāṇaṃ puruṣaṃ tapasā hata.kilbiṣaṃ | 4.243a[244Ma]
paralokaṃ nayaty āśu bhāsvantaṃ kha.śarīriṇaṃ | | 243 | | 4.243c[244Mc]*

— Manusmṛti, 4.1.23. Accumulating Merit (Chapter 23), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Manusmṛti, in this verse, paints a vivid picture of the transformative power of dharma. It speaks of a person who prioritizes righteousness, a 'dharma-pradhana purusha', and whose impurities, 'kilbisha', have been eradicated through the fire of spiritual discipline, 'tapas'. Such an individual, the verse assures us, is swiftly guided to the afterlife, 'paraloka', in a radiant, ethereal form, 'bhasvantaṃ kha.śarīriṇaṃ'.

This isn't simply about adhering to rigid rules, but cultivating an inner state of being. Dharma, in this context, is not just about ritualistic observances but about living a life aligned with truth, compassion, and integrity. The 'tapas' or spiritual discipline, isn't necessarily about extreme asceticism, but about consistent self-reflection, mindful action, and unwavering commitment to ethical conduct. It is through this sustained effort that the accumulated impurities of the mind – ego, greed, anger – are gradually purified.

The promise of a radiant afterlife is not a literal guarantee of a heavenly abode but a symbolic representation of the liberation that comes from living a life of purpose and virtue. When you live in alignment with your higher self, embracing dharma as your guiding principle, you naturally radiate positivity, wisdom, and peace. This inner radiance, this 'bhasvantaṃ' quality, becomes your true form, your 'kha.śarīriṇaṃ', transcending the limitations of the physical body.

In modern life, this verse encourages us to examine our priorities. Are we chasing fleeting pleasures or cultivating lasting values? Are we driven by ego or guided by compassion? The 'tapas' required may involve practices like meditation, selfless service, or simply making conscious choices that align with our deepest values. By prioritizing dharma in our daily lives, we not only contribute to a more just and compassionate world but also pave the way for our own inner transformation, moving towards a state of greater clarity, peace, and fulfillment. The afterlife, in a sense, begins now, in the quality of our present moment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you willing to commit to one small act of 'tapas' today, a conscious effort to purify your thoughts, words, or actions? How might this simple act ripple outwards, transforming not only yourself but also the world around you?